

# Gihun Im

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## EDUCATION

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### Ph.D. Student in Counseling Psychology

Aug 2024 – Present

The University of Iowa, Iowa City, IA, United States  
Advisor: Amanda S. Case, Ph.D.  
GPA: 4.22

### M.A. in Educational Counseling

Mar 2022 – Feb 2024

Seoul National University, Seoul, South Korea  
Advisor: Dongil Kim, Ph.D.

Thesis: Korean school counselors' counseling competencies and advocacy activities for LGBTQ+ youth: A latent profile analysis  
GPA: 4.26

### B.A. in English Education & B.A. in Psychology

Mar 2011 – Feb 2018

Chung-Ang University, Seoul, South Korea, *dual degree*  
GPA: 4.14, *Magna Cum Laude*

## PROFESSIONAL AND CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

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### Special Graduate Assistant

Aug 2026 – Present

Iowa Testing Programs, University of Iowa  
Supervisor: Amanda S. Case, Ph.D.

- Selected as the department's recipient based on outstanding potential
- Coordinate research, program development, and knowledge translation across multiple initiatives, including NPEA and community-based college success projects

### Counseling Psychology Trainee

Aug 2026 – Present

Holden Comprehensive Cancer Center, University of Iowa Health Care  
Supervisor: Gregory L. Gullickson, Ph.D.

- Provide brief individual therapy to patients diagnosed with cancer

### Research Assistant

Nov 2025 – May 2026

Department of Counselor Education, University of Iowa  
Supervisor: Isak Kim, Ph.D.

- Coordinated counseling research projects involving IRB protocol development, Qualtrics survey design, and participant recruitment
- Analyzed large-scale data sets (e.g., Healthy Minds Study) and contributed to manuscript preparation
- Contributed to internal and external grant applications focused on counselor training, digital mental health, and underserved populations

### Graduate Research Assistant

Mar 2025 – May 2026

Telepsychology Training Clinic, University of Iowa  
Supervisor: Martin Kivlighan, Ph.D.

- Managed administrative tasks related to clinic operations
- Maintained connections with community resources to support rural mental health
- Coordinated workshops and outreach activities

**Doctoral Trainee**

Aug 2024 – May 2026

University Counseling Service, University of Iowa

Supervisor: Patrick Galligan, Ph.D.

- Provide brief individual therapy for undergraduate and graduate students
- Conduct initial consultation and single-session intervention
- Engage in outreach activities to promote campus mental health awareness
- Facilitate group therapy

**Graduate Research Assistant**

Aug 2024 – May 2025

Department of Psychological and Quantitative Foundations, University of Iowa

Supervisor: Julie M. Koch, Ph.D.

- Conducted literature reviews and preliminary regression analyses examining LGBTQ+ mental health outcomes within interdisciplinary research collaborations
- Conducted literature reviews and developed practice guideline outlines for therapists working in international and LGBTQ+-neutral contexts
- Supported ongoing research and departmental scholarly initiatives
- Assisted the department coordinator with administrative tasks

**Certified School Counselor**

Mar 2024 – Aug 2024

Dangsan Middle School, *Full-time*

- Provided individual/group counseling for middle school students (450+ students)
- Delivered social-emotional learning (SEL) and anti-bullying programs

**Intern Counselor**

Mar 2022 – Feb 2024

SNU Center for Campus Life &amp; Culture, Seoul National University

- Provided counseling and performed psychological assessments for undergraduate and graduate students
- Led and co-led group counseling programs

**Research Assistant**

Mar 2022 – Feb 2024

Department of Education, Seoul National University

Supervisor: Dongil Kim, Ph.D.

- Conducted quantitative and qualitative research on LGBTQ+ mental health, counselor training, career development, and youth intervention programs
- Utilized diverse methodologies, including structural equation modeling (SEM), factor analysis, latent class and profile analysis (LCA/LPA), mediation/moderation modeling, Delphi methods, focus group interviews (FGIs), thematic analysis, consensual qualitative research (CQR), and program evaluation
- Supported research dissemination through manuscript preparation, conference presentations, literature reviews, survey development, and data analysis

**Certified School Counselor**

Mar 2019 – Feb 2022

Seoul Metropolitan Office of Education (headquarters), *Full-time*

- Contributed to creating government policies and guidelines for the school counseling system in Seoul
- Developed counseling and guidance programs for 1,300+ school counseling offices (*Wee Class*) and 26 centers (*Wee Center*) in Seoul
- Implemented crisis intervention programs and conducted counseling services for both students and staff members impacted by traumatic events (7 different occasions)
- Provided psychological consulting as a consultant to school staff members and caregivers
- Offered counseling services to students with mental, academic, and/or developmental issues
- Delivered anti-bullying programs as a lecturer for students who have engaged in school violence, as well as their caregivers

**TEACHING EXPERIENCE**

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**Teaching Assistant**

Fall 2026

PSQF:6223 Introduction to Counseling Psychology Practice/Research

Department of Psychological and Quantitative Foundations, University of Iowa

- Facilitate class discussions and deliver instruction on various topics in counseling psychology

## Guest Lecturer

Spring 2026

CSED:6353 Pre-Practicum & Case Management in Counseling  
Department of Counselor Education, University of Iowa

## Teaching Assistant

Spring 2026

PSQF:7310 Intelligence Assessment

Department of Psychological and Quantitative Foundations, University of Iowa

- Scored assignments and provided feedback on intelligence assessment administrations (WAIS-5, WISC-5, WIAT-4, NEPSY-II, D-KEFS, SB-5, BASC-2)

## PUBLICATIONS

[KCI] denotes the Korean Citation Index, indicating that the article is in Korean.

### PEER-REVIEWED JOURNALS

5. **Im, G., & Kim, D.** (in press). Korean school counselors' counseling competencies and advocacy activities for LGBTQ+ youth: A latent profile analysis. *Current Psychology*.
4. **Im, G.** (2026). Ethical risk prevention in client generative artificial intelligence (genAI) use: Applying the primary risk-management model. *American Psychologist*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1037/amp0001731>
3. Kim, D., **Im, G.**, Chung, G., & Park, J. (2025). Impact of discussion activity in international youth exchange programs on global citizenship: Mediating role of multicultural competence. *Journal of Education & Culture*, 31(1), 597–613. [KCI]
2. Kim, D., Park, J., & **Im, G.** (2025). Research on developing a social enrichment program for young adults with borderline intellectual functioning. *Disability & Employment*, 35(1), 163–186. [KCI]
1. Kim, D., Park, J., Lee, J., Park, I., & **Im, G.** (2023). Exploring subjects of standardized curriculum for youth counselors in South Korea by Delphi method. *Studies on Korean Youth*, 34(4), 141–162. [KCI]

### MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

4. **Im, G.** (under review). Outing-related threat and depression among sexual minority adults during the COVID-19 pandemic: Internalized homophobia and the dual role of community connectedness.
3. Kim, I., **Im, G.**, Min, Y., & Ding, R. (under review). Ambivalent engagement with generative AI: Greater mental health use and concern among college students with anxiety-depression.
2. Kim, J., Kang, S., **Im, G.**, & Kim, M. (under review). A systematic review and meta-synthesis on LGBTQ+ partner bereavement: Grief trajectories toward an ecological framework.
1. **Im, G.**, Case, A. S., Bae, I., Ji, S., Tang, Y., & Zhang, Y. (under review). User engagement with ChatGPT for mental health support: A mixed-method meta-analysis.

### MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

2. **Im, G.**, Jun, E., Yoon, H., & Case, A. S. (in preparation). LGBTQ+ educators in South Korea: A photovoice study on marginalization, resilience, and advocacy.
1. Bae, I., & **Im, G.** (in preparation). Relationship between decent education and decent work for youth: Mediating effects of work volition and career adaptability.

## RESEARCH GRANTS

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2. **Lee Chang Kook Fund: Queer Research Grant** Aug 2025 – Aug 2026  
Beyond the Rainbow Foundation  
LGBTQ+ educators in South Korea: A photovoice study  
Principal Investigator  
\$1,200
1. **Mary Bywater Cross and Robert P. Newman Research Award** Oct 2024 – May 2025  
College of Education, University of Iowa  
The relationship between perceived threat of COVID-19, internalized stigma, and depression among LGB individuals: Moderated mediating role of community connectedness  
Principal Investigator  
\$1,000

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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13. **Im, G.**, Case, A. S., Bae, I., Ji, S., Tang, Y., & Zhang, Y. (2026, August 6–8). *User engagement with ChatGPT for mental health support: A mixed-method meta-analysis* [Poster presentation]. Division 17 Student Poster Session, APA 2026 Annual Convention, Washington, DC, United States.
12. Zoet, Z., **Im, G.**, Lazo-Salmeron, W., Karimzadeh, L., Park, E., Jensen, S., Clarke, W. F., Perez, J., & Campos, D. (2026, August 6–8). *Critical reflections & action: Moving values from theory to practice* [Invited address]. APA 2026 Annual Convention, Washington, DC, United States.
11. **Im, G.** (2026, August 6–8). *Ethical risk prevention in client generative AI use: Applying the primary risk-management model* [Poster presentation]. APA 2026 Convention, Washington, DC, United States.
10. Zhang, Y., Ben, L., **Im, G.**, & Tang, Y. (2026, February 26–28). *How counselors navigate religious/spiritual value conflict in counseling: A scoping review* [Poster presentation]. SPSP 2026 Annual Convention, Chicago, IL, United States.
9. Kim, J., Kang, S., **Im, G.**, & Kim, M. (2025, August 7–9). *A decade later: Revisiting LGBTQ+ partner loss and bereavement in the post-same-sex marriage era* [Poster presentation]. APA 2025 Convention, Denver, CO, United States.
8. Tang, Y., **Im, G.**, & Zhang, Y. (2025, August 7–9). *Community efforts in promoting youth resilience: A systematic review of community-based intervention* [Poster presentation]. APA 2025 Convention, Denver, CO, United States.
7. Kim, J., Kang, S., **Im, G.**, & Kim, M. (2025, July 11). *A decade later: Revisiting LGBTQ+ partner loss and bereavement in the post-same-sex marriage era* [Paper presentation]. 2025 Korean Association for LGBTQ+ and Queer Studies, Seoul, South Korea.
6. Ko, J., Park, J., **Im, G.**, Cheung, S., & Reid-Marks, L. (2024, August 8–10). *Social stigma, social status, work volition, social support, and positive identity in LGB college students in Korea* [Poster presentation]. APA 2024 Convention, Seattle, WA, United States.
5. Koch, J. M., Shin, Y.-J., Lee, J., & **Im, G.** (2024, July 21–26). *Affirmative psychological practice in LGBTQ-neutral countries* [Poster presentation]. The 33rd International Congress of Psychology, Prague, Czech Republic.
4. Bae, I., & **Im, G.** (2024, June 5). *Relationships between decent education and decent work for youth: Mediating effects of work volition and career adaptability* [Paper presentation]. 2024 Employment Survey Conference, Seoul, South Korea.
3. **Im, G.** (2024, July 19). *Relationships between perceived threat of COVID-19, internalized stigma, and depression among LGB people: Focusing on the moderating effects of community connectedness* [Paper presentation]. The 1st Conference of Junior Scholars Network of LGBTIQ Research, Seoul, South Korea.

2. **Im, G.** (2023, October 11–13). *Overcoming the limitations of school-based suicide post interventions: Focusing on the experiences of key staff members of “Wee Center”* [Poster presentation]. The 23rd International Conference of Educational Research, Seoul, South Korea.
1. Yoon-Lee, S., & **Im, G.** (2023, October 1–31). *“Are we on the same page?”: The critical autoethnography of Korean queer counselors* [Paper presentation]. Society for Sexual, Affectional, Intersex, and Gender Expressive Identities (SAIGE) 2023 Virtual Conference.

## **SCHOLARSHIPS, FELLOWSHIPS, AWARDS, AND HONORS**

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Audrey Qualls Travel Award</b><br>College of Education, University of Iowa                       | 2025, 2026  |
| <b>Office of the Dean Graduate Student Travel Award</b><br>College of Education, University of Iowa | 2025, 2026  |
| <b>Graduate Tuition Scholarship</b><br>College of Education, University of Iowa                     | 2025        |
| <b>Distinguished Student Research Award</b><br>Korea Employment Information Service                 | 2024        |
| <b>Semester High Honors</b><br>College of Education, Seoul National University                      | 2023        |
| <b>Brain Korea 21 (BK-21) Plus Scholarship</b><br>Seoul National University                         | 2022, 2023  |
| <b>Superintendent's Citation of Merit</b><br>Seoul Metropolitan Superintendent of Education         | 2021        |
| <b>Scholarship for CAU Alumni Association</b><br>Chung-Ang University Alumni Association            | 2017        |
| <b>Semester High Honors</b><br>College of Education, Chung-Ang University                           | 2017        |
| <b>Mentorship Grant</b><br>Korea Foundation for the Advancement of Science and Creativity (KOFAC)   | 2016        |
| <b>National Scholarship</b><br>Korea Student Aid Foundation                                         | 2012 – 2017 |

## **LEADERSHIP, SERVICE, AND RELATED EXPERIENCE**

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### **ADVOCACY & ACTIVISM**

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>Operational Board</b><br>The EE-MM: Network for Queer and Transgender Counselors in Korea         | Jul 2022 – Present  |
| <b>Junior Ombudsperson</b><br>SNU Human Rights Center, Seoul National University                     | May 2022 – Aug 2022 |
| <b>Certified Teacher Member</b><br>LGBTQ Youth Crisis Support Center “Ddingdong”, Seoul, South Korea | Feb 2020 – Present  |
| <b>Chairperson</b><br>QUV: Solidarity of University Queer Societies in Korea                         | Sep 2015 – Feb 2016 |
| <b>President</b><br>LGBTQ+ Student Club “Rainbow Fish”, Chung-Ang University, Seoul, South Korea     | Mar 2015 – Feb 2016 |

## LEADERSHIP & PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

### **International Committee Co-Chair**

Aug 2025 – Present

Student Affiliates of Seventeen (SAS) Executive Board, APA Division 17

- Lead the International Committee in developing initiatives that support the professional development of international counseling psychology students
- Collaborate with the Executive Board to integrate international perspectives into SAS programming and advocacy efforts

### **Advisory Board**

May 2019 – Feb 2021

National Human Rights Commission of the Republic of Korea

### **Editorial Committee**

May 2020 – Nov 2020

Task Force for School Counseling System (*Wee Project*), Korea Educational Development Institute (KEDI)

## EDITORIAL SERVICE

### **Ad Hoc Reviewer**

Journal of Prevention & Health Promotion

2026 – Present

Translational Issues in Psychological Science

2026 – Present

Psychology of Sexual Orientation and Gender Diversity

2026 – Present

Current Psychology

2026 – Present

## COMMUNITY SERVICE

### **Instructor**

May 2026 – Jul 2026

Every Underachieving Student Succeeds Program, Seoul National University

### **Program Facilitator**

Jun 2023 – Jul 2023

Global Youth Summit, The National Council of Youth Organizations in Korea

### **Instructor**

May 2022 – Jul 2022

Every Underachieving Student Succeeds Program, Seoul National University

### **Teaching Intern**

Jul 2016 – Dec 2016

Korea Foundation for the Advancement of Science and Creativity (KOFAC)

### **Teaching Staff**

Jul 2013 – Aug 2014

Pyeongtaek Regional Support Center for Children, Gyeonggi-do, South Korea

## EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

### **Student Reporter**

Jul 2015 – Dec 2015

Editorial Team, Daehaknaeil, South Korea

## MILITARY SERVICE

### **Legal Assistant**

Aug 2012 – Aug 2014

Legal Office, Air Force Operations Command, Gyeonggi-do, South Korea

## SKILLS

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**Language:** Korean (native), English (fluent), Japanese (working proficiency)

**Statistical Programs:** SPSS (PROCESS macro), AMOS, *Mplus*, R, jamovi and STATA

## CERTIFICATIONS

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>Certified Counselor</b> , Korean Psychological Association (KPA)                                        | 2023 |
| <b>Survey Analyst</b> , Human Resources Development Service of Korea                                       | 2021 |
| <b>Certified School Counselor</b> , Korean Ministry of Education ( <i>National Teacher Certification</i> ) | 2018 |
| <b>Certified Secondary English Teacher</b> , Korean Ministry of Education                                  | 2018 |

## PROFESSIONAL/COMMUNITY AFFILIATIONS

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American Psychological Association  
Division 17, Society of Counseling Psychology  
Division 44, Society for the Psychology of Sexual Orientation and Gender Diversity  
Korean Psychological Association  
Division 2, Korean Counseling Psychology Association  
Korean Counseling Association (KCA)  
KCA-International Chapter  
Korean Association for LGBTQ+ and Queer Studies  
Korean Psychology Network  
LGBTQ Youth Crisis Support Center “Ddingdong”  
The EE-MM: Network for Queer and Transgender Counselors in Korea

## REFERENCES

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Julie M. Koch, Ph.D.  
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